Hugo Sant'Anna

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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Alabama at Birmingham 2025–present

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Georgia May 2025
M.Sc., Economics, Baylor University May 2020
B.A., Industrial Engineering, IBMEC-RJ Dec 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics, Applied Microeconomics

PUBLICATIONS

1. "Mass Incarceration Reforms: The Alabama Experience" [link]
   with Griffin Edwards and Ben Meadows
   Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy, 2026
2. "Labor Market Effects of the Venezuelan Refugee Crisis in Brazil" [link]
   with Samyam Shrestha
   Journal of Economic Geography, 2026
3. "The End of Free Movement and International Migration" [link]
   with Samyam Shrestha
   Economics Letters, 2025

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Down the River: Labor Market Effects of Brazil's Worst Environmental Disaster" [link]
   with Débora Mazetto and Kelly Santos
   Revise and resubmit, *Labour Economics*
2. "Difference-in-Differences with 'Bad Controls'" [link]
   with Carolina Caetano, Brantly Callaway, and Stroud Payne
   Previously known as "Difference in Differences with Time-Varying Covariates"
3. "AI Exposure and Entrepreneurship" [link]
   with Samyam Shrestha
4. "Immigration Enforcement and Local Business Dynamics" [link]
   with Samyam Shrestha
5. "Does Employer-Based Immigration Enforcement Reduce the Undocumented Immigrant Population? Re-examining the Effects of LAWA" [link]
   with Samyam Shrestha
6. "Gender Differences in Comparative Advantage Matches: Evidence from Linked Employer-Employee Data" [link]
   Job market paper

SOFTWARE

badcontrols — R package for difference-in-differences with bad controls [github]
labormarket — R package for limited mobility bias in matched employer-employee data [github]
bRunching — R package for the CCN bunching correction estimator [github]
clo-author — Claude Code scaffold for empirical economics research [github]

TEACHING AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Alabama at Birmingham

Managerial Economics (MBA)	2025–2026
Principles of Microeconomics	2025–2026
Intermediate Microeconomics	2025–2026

Instructor of Record, University of Georgia

Principles of Macroeconomics	S 2024, Sum 2023

Research Assistant, University of Georgia

Dr. Ian Schmutte	2021–2024
Dr. Brantly Callaway	2022–2024

Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia

Econometrics (Graduate)	F 2024, F 2023, S 2023, S 2022
Labor Economics (Graduate)	F 2024, F 2023, F 2022
Introduction to Data Science for Business	Sum 2022, F 2021
Econometrics (Undergraduate)	S 2021

Teaching & Research Assistant, Baylor University

Causal Inference (Dr. Scott Cunningham)	S 2020
Behavioral Economics (Dr. Jaison Aimone)	F 2019, S 2020
Microeconomics (Dr. Scott Cunningham)	S 2019, F 2018

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: American Journal of Agricultural Economics, Criminological Encounters, Economics Letters, The Econometrics Journal, Journal of Econometrics, Journal of Regional Science, The Journal of the Economics of Ageing, Statistical Papers

Abstract Reviewer, AAEA Annual Meeting	2023, 2025
Organizer, UGA 'Metrics Reading Group, University of Georgia [link]	2024
Machine Learning Consultant, Food Science and Technology Dept., UGA	2023
R code for Scott Cunningham's *Causal Inference: The Mixtape* [link]	2019–2020

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Tennessee Tech University (seminar)	2026
American Economic Association Meetings	2025
North American Econometric Society Summer Meeting	2024
Western Economic Association International Conference	2024
Midwest Economics Association Conference	2024
Southern Economic Association Conference	2022–2025

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Center for Teaching and Learning, UGA	2024
Swift Undergraduate Teaching Fellowship, Terry College of Business, UGA	2024
Dissertation Research Award, Department of Economics, UGA	2024
UGA Representative, Southern Economic Association Graduate Session	2024
Travel Grant, Portuguese–Latin American Studies Institute, UGA	2024
Graduate School Travel Grant, University of Georgia	2023

SKILLS

Programming: R, Python, MATLAB, Stata, C++, LaTeX
Languages: Portuguese (native), English

Updated on October 9, 2026.